

Did you do follow-up trips where you wagered more meaningful amounts?

No, and there were multiple reasons why I didn't. First, blackjack was rolling full blast and occupying a good chunk of my time. Second, not long afterward, I accepted a position at New Mexico State University, which made continued collaboration with Shannon difficult. Third, I questioned whether I wanted to pursue a venture where I had to disguise myself. Fourth, everyone else was really scared.

They were afraid of . . .

Casino violence.

Yes, I would imagine. It was one of the questions I was going to ask you about. You say everyone else; what about yourself?

For some reason I never was scared.

Why?

I just don't scare. I am aware, and I avoid taking foolish risks. When I was playing blackjack in Las Vegas, I always made sure I was around people and lights.

But that wouldn't have helped if the casino caught you.

That's true. If they caught you, they would drag you into the back room and beat you. But at this point, I felt I had a shield of publicity from my blackjack exposure in the press. If they had done anything to me, I could really have made them look bad. I think they probably knew that. Many years later, I learned that they did discuss whether to do me in. In 1964, there was a huge meeting of the Nevada Resort Hotel Association in Las Vegas after *Life* magazine published an article titled *The Professor Who Breaks the Bank*, which created a lot of publicity for blackjack betting systems. The article caused a huge uproar among the casino owners, and they had a meeting to discuss what to do about it. Thirty years later, a fellow by the name of Vic Vickrey who was at the meeting wrote an article about it. Apparently, they discussed various alternatives including getting rid of me and breaking knees. Fortunately for me, they settled on the right option, which was changing the rules.